

Vertigo!!!

Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 673 November 2004 PO BOX 1 6 2 8 W E L L I N G T O N

Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea and coffee afterwards.



Section Night: Monday 1 November 2004:

“The Most Fun You Can Have With Your Clothes on”

Last month it was Dave Vass. This month it's Dave Langrish. Dave will be talking and showing slides about ski touring in NZ. Although his talk won't appeal to naturists and nudists, it will be of a great deal of interest to those who want to know more about ski touring on Ruapehu, Tongariro and in the Southern Alps.

Dave has been rock climbing and mountaineering for 25 years. He served his climbing apprenticeship in the UK and Europe and has climbed extensively in North America. Dave has also worked in outdoor education since 1986 at places including the Sir Edmund Hillary Outdoor Pursuits Centre, the Pacific Crest Outward Bound School in California and Plas y Brenin in North Wales.

Dave jokes that he's a split personality: he works both as a physics teacher at Wgtn College and as a guide for Alpine Guides at Mt Cook. He's an NZMGA qualified mountain and ski guide.





Section trips news

Please send all your fantastic trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories. The last two months have been a bit sparse, so I look forward to receiving your stories as the summer season kicks in!

Pete's Post

After one 7-hour return flight which got as far as the edge of the Antarctic circle, I finally made it to Scott Base last Saturday. We flew in a C141 Starlifter, which has webbing seats and very little leg-room. You sit facing the opposite row of people, and are so close to them that your feet need to be alternated with theirs. You must wear all your heavy ECW clothing (Extreme Cold Weather), despite the temperature in the aircraft reaching 29 degrees C.

When we landed it was minus 25 degrees, but it has since been unseasonably warm at -12 to -18 degrees.

We started our field training almost as soon as we arrived. This involves learning to self-arrest, kick steps, make a snow shelter etc. I definitely learned something. We slept the night in snow shelters and Antarctic tents, which are tall canvas pyramid shapes – just the same design as Scott and Shackleton used almost a hundred years ago.

We also learned how to assess the thickness of the sea ice by drilling through it with a hand auger and lowering a tape-measure through the hole. It needs to be at least 75cm thick to safely support a vehicle.

I had one afternoon of vehicle training, and can now drive a Hagglunds, which is an articulated tracked vehicle. It looks like one bulldozer towing another one, only there is no blade at the front. The other vehicle I can drive is a PistenBully. This is a snowgroomer with a passenger cab at the back. And no blade in front. Both vehicles are fun to drive.

I've only just started learning how to do my job. I do weather observations at 9am each morning. The instruments are inside, and in a box outside. It is sometimes uncomfortable writing down the data when you take your gloves off on a cold day, but we're tough down here. Might be a different story once it gets to -50 degrees though.

Most of the experiments measure atmospheric values by looking at what frequencies of light are absorbed by various chemicals in the air. Or they use radio energy reflections to see what is happening above us. The ozone layer is looking pretty good above us at the moment.

I've been allocated a couple of helicopter flights onto Mt Erebus to help carry batteries for the radio repeater station, but these keep getting cancelled due to high winds.

I went cross-country skiing on the sea ice after dinner last night. The sun is still setting for a few hours each night at about 11pm, so you have plenty of time to go out and play. In a few weeks the sun won't set at all. This sounds great, but you need to make sure you don't overdo things, because the work during the day is complex and important. When winter rolls around we will have permanent darkness, so we need to enjoy the sun while we can.

Pete de Joux from Antarctica



Taranaki Alpine Club 75th Jubilee

The Taranaki Alpine Club's 75th Jubilee is now being planned for Queens Birthday weekend (4th & 5th June 2005) and will be held in New Plymouth. The theme of the reunion will be Trips-Outings-Events.

If you have any photographs or slides that you would like to contribute for inclusion at the celebrations please contact:

John Jordan
Convener 75th Jubilee Committee
254 Johns Rd, RD8, Inglewood, New Zealand
phone/fax 06 7624752
email jd.jordan@xtra.co.nz

Any material will be returned as soon as it has been scanned. For anyone wishing to join in the celebrations please contact John Jordan. We look forward to your company.

Greg Hall
Taranaki Alpine Club



Lost mountaineers

I know this might be a long shot but I need to find a group of Kiwi mountaineers last seen on the Haute Route circa 1966-67. The reason I ask is that my uncle, Ernst Doll is trying to get in touch with these guys after all these years, he was part of a German team who stumbled across the kiwis in difficulty. What the Kiwis lacked in equipment, the Germans lacked in food, so between them they finished the trek and became good friends.

My uncle is retiring soon and plans a trip to NZ, it would be great to reunite the friends.

Owen Doll
arkeyteqt@hotmail.com



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Employment opportunity

Jones and Cooper Ltd of Gore, Southland, have been contracted by the Department of Conservation to build the new Plateau Hut in Aoraki/Mt Cook National Park. The hut is being assembled in Gore and will be disassembled for packaging into manageable helicopter loads. Once on site it will be reassembled on the steel sub structure.

Peter Cooper requires the services of approximately four experienced carpenters who are also mountaineers and are capable of working in this alpine environment. For further details contact Peter Cooper on 0274358577



Photo Comp

Congratulations go to Peter Laurenson, who did extremely well during the Wellington section's 2004 Photo Competition in June (with champion or honours slides in almost every category), and since then has gone on to win two coveted championship positions in the national level photographic competition.

Peter Laurenson's "Reflected Ants" was the national champion Alpine Activity photograph and was also the subject of a full-colour A2 poster inserted into the most recent edition of the NZAC's "Climber" magazine. What is more, Peter's "Cultural Collision" slide also won the Photojournalism category of the competition.

Take a bow Peter Laurenson -- a true champion!



Titahi Bay Rebolting

Heaps of thanks to Kristen Foley and the seven volunteers who turned up at Titahi Bay a couple of weeks ago to undertake a rebolting project just in time for summer! Mike tells me the day spent bolting was a great day out. Several climbs got new belay bolts, some very dubious bolts were replaced or removed, and a lot of learning took place.

Please note that if you are climbing out there Whitireia Park Board have written to the Section regarding the bolting and protection. They have advised us that they will erect a sign which states "that neither they nor DOC are responsible for installation, inspection or maintenance of fixed gear, including bolts, placed in the area. The sign will advise that climbers use this gear at their own risk." The contact for this is Liz Paton, DOC Recreation Planner, 04 470 8421.



For Tender

As the Wgtn Section has now purchased a sparkly new slide projector the old slide projector is now surplus to requirements. A number of enquiries have been received regarding what will happen to it and we have now decided to offer it for tender. So if you want it then let the treasurer (Caroline on treasurer@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz) know how much you are willing to pay for it!



Bevan Col air access issues

The views of the Wellington section are being canvassed on this issue. If you have an opinion you wish to share, please email Alan Lowrie on al@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



The answer to Quiz Number 13

The chairperson's 13th quiz question was who was the first woman to climb the Matterhorn. The answer is Lucy Walker, who climbed it in 1871. About half-a-dozen correct answers were submitted to Nigel Roberts, and Monty Vass-- Dave Vass' son -- drew Murray Presland's name as the winner. The Matterhorn is on the Swiss-Italian border and the mountain's Italian name is Cervino, so Murray's prize was, appropriately, a bottle of Italian white wine.

Incidentally, the chairperson's 13th quiz should serve as a warning to those of you who use Google to try to find answers to the questions posed by Nigel Roberts. A large number of Google entries claim that "in 1985 Annie Smith Peck became the first woman to climb the Matterhorn", which is -- of course-- total rubbish. (*She was the first American woman I believe -- Ed*)



Quiz Number 14

Nigel Roberts noted that not only had the film "Touching the Void" been very popular in Wellington, but also that Simon Yates will possibly be coming to New Zealand on a lecture tour early next year. Simon Yates and Joe Simpson are, of course, famous for their dramatic first ascent of the west face of Siula Grande in Peru, so Nigel's 14th quiz question is: Name one of Simon Yates' first ascents in another country beginning with "P", namely Pakistan.

Nigel is overseas (working, not climbing Mt Blanc this time, we are told), which means that you have a long time to answer this one. Email your answers to Nigel at [<chairperson@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz>](mailto:chairperson@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz) by the end of November (that is, by no later than Tuesday, 30 November 2004). Be sure to put Quiz Number 14 in the email subject line (or else your email is highly likely to be destroyed as spam).

The winning entry will be drawn at the Monday, 6 December, section night meeting, and the winner will receive a bottle of Christmas cheer (which almost certainly won't be Pakistani wine!).



39 Mercer Street, PO Box 1560, Wellington, New Zealand
Ph/Fax (04) 4735353 email mainly.tramping@paradise.net.nz



And here are the club trips...

Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the section, so if anyone has an idea about a trip, no matter how vague, come and chat to Michele Domaneschi or Rachel Depree (trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz).

Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us, or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going.

See you in the hills!

Trips for the Calendar for the rest of 2004...

Check out the proposed and planned new list for 2004. We need trip organisers to put their hands up for what are bound to be outstanding adventures. There's something for everyone in here with a mix of snow, rock and even a spot of ski touring.

Proposed...

Tasman Saddle	<i>13 – 21 November 2004</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Alpine	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate – Advanced
<i>Organiser:</i> Looking for a volunteer	
Fly into Tasman Saddle hut for a week and tackle some of the peaks as well as sort out or polish up on glacier travel etc.	

Arthurs Pass	<i>11 – 19 December 2004</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Alpine/Rock	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate - Advanced
<i>Organiser:</i> Looking for a volunteer	
Stay in Arthurs Pass or at Castle Hill village for alpine or rock. Lots of options and opportunity to take a week off.	

Definite...

Tapuae-o-Uenuku	<i>23, 24, 25 October 2004 (Labour weekend)</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Alpine	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate - Advanced
<i>Organiser:</i> Andrew Finnegan. Email Andrew.Finnegan@wcc.govt.nz	
3-4 day trip into Tapuae-o-Uenuku with lots of opportunities to get your feet wet.	

Patagonia	<i>10 or 17 Dec 2004 - 9 Jan 2005</i>
<i>Trip type:</i> Overseas Expedition	<i>Level:</i> Intermediate - Advanced
<i>Organiser:</i> Daniel Joll, email Daniel@jadepromotions.co.nz phone 021 732 004	
We will be going to Torres del Paine national park. The trip will be based around climbing one or more of the towers. However, if people are interested in coming along there is also great tramping in the area. The more the merrier.	



MOVED HOUSE?

Please notify the Club's National Administrator of your change of address as the labels for all newsletters and club publications are generated at the HQ office.

You can contact:

Margaret McMahon
National Administrator
email office@alpineclub.org.nz

NZAC
PO BOX 786
CHRISTCHURCH
TEL (03) 377 7595
FAX (03) 337 7594)



HANGDOG INDOOR CLIMBING CAVERN

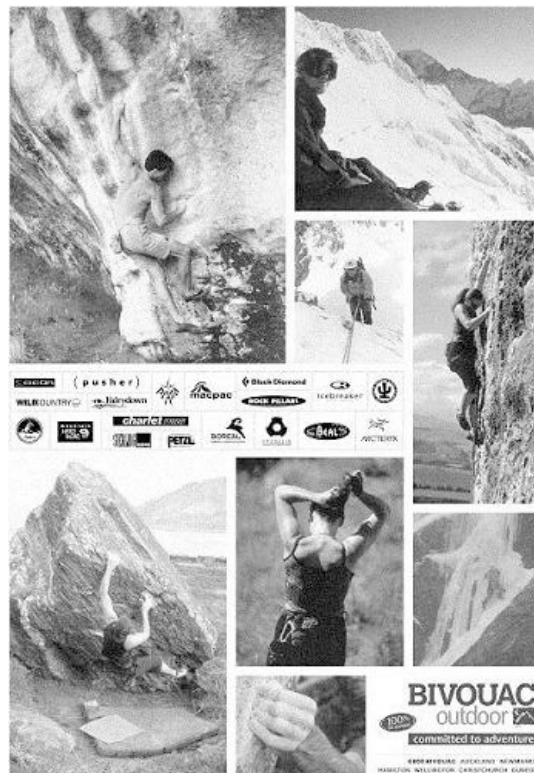
Come down and see us for all your climbing and bouldering needs. We have heaps of good routes from grade 14 through to 30 and the only bouldering room in Wellington!

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Bored at work?

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earth sea sky and
the climber present

the climber magazine 50th issue creative writing competition

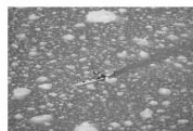
The summer issue of *the climber* will be our 50th, and to celebrate we are announcing a creative writing contest open to all readers of *the climber*. There is a total \$1250 prize pool on offer and the best entries we receive will be published in the magazine. Stories can be either fiction or non-fiction, but an additional award will be given to the best pure fiction piece we receive.

Criteria and entry details

- 1500 words maximum
- Topic should be climbing, or associated with climbing and must be set in New Zealand
- Entries should be emailed to climber@alpineclub.org.nz as a MS Word, RTF or Text file attachment, or via post on floppy or CD to The Climber, PO Box 786, Christchurch
- Deadline for entries Monday 8 November

Prizes include performance clothing from Earth Sea Sky, a full set of NZAC alpine region guidebooks and a signed copy of Colin Monteath's *Under a Sheltering Sky*.

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Thanks to Earth Sea Sky and Hedgehog House for their support.



Still Bored at work?

Then start writing for vertiGO or be prepared for the next issue to be filled with more random photos from the sub-editors collection!



Wellington Section Directory: 2003 contact list

Position	Name	E-mail Alias*	Phone
Patron			
Chairperson	Nigel Roberts	CHAIRPERSON <i>or</i> NR	(04) 475 7543
Vice Chairperson			
Secretary	Garth London	SECRETARY <i>or</i> GL	(04) 479 2984
Treasurer	Caroline Duggan	TREASURER <i>or</i> CD	(04) 475 5542
National Representative	Caroline Duggan	CD	(04) 475 5542
	Nigel Roberts	NR	(04) 475 7543
Instruction: AIC	Caroline Duggan	AIC	(04) 475 5542
Instruction: RIC	Scott Taylor	SPRINGROCK	N/A
Trips	Michele Domaneschi	TRIPS <i>or</i> MD	N/A
	Rachel Depree	RD	N/A
Library	Derek Richardson	LIBRARY	N/A
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	(04) 934 7926
Committee Members	Tom Bowen	TB	N/A
	Rachel Depree	RD	N/A
	Michele Domaneschi	MD	N/A
	Pete de Joux	PDJ	N/A
	Alan Lowrie	AL	N/A
	Mike O'Brien	MOB	(04) 380 0913
	Rachael Schmidt	RS	(04) 470 4479
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	(04) 934 7926
Palmerston North Contact	John Barnes	JB	(06) 357 0654
Newsletter Editor	Rachael Schmidt	NEWSLETTER <i>or</i> RS	(04) 470 4479
Webmeister	Jane Furkert	WEBMASTER <i>or</i> JF	N/A
National President	Dave Bamford	DB	N/A
National President Elect	Judy Reid	JR	N/A
National Vice Pres. (NI)	Nigel Roberts	NR	(04) 475 7543

* Email address is alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, eg: secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz